reserves of fuel, oils and lubricants, maintenance and repair of vehicles, and stocking of reserves of rations by the Food Corporation of India are some of the areas where the civilian sector has stepped in. Besides this, my thrust was on automation and computerized inventory control. As a first step, we were able to implement a pilot project of automation in the ordnance depot at Delhi. This is being followed up in other logistics installations in a phased manner. I firmly believe in the concept of 'just enough and just in time' in the domain of logistics. We have to grow out of the habit of overinsurance and overstocking by maintenance of reserves at all levels as if we are operating in an overseas theatre. As our indigenous production capability is going up, it must result in reduced holdings except items being imported, and thereby bring in savings.

The EME was given greater capability to carry out repairs in field conditions, and as far forward as conditions permitted. Major restructuring and modernization of the base workshops was commenced in a phased manner. This was to facilitate overhauls and base repairs of the tanks, guns and other equipment. Repairs of vehicles and other equipment was offloaded to the original equipment manufacturers and trade to the extent possible, so that EME manpower and facilities could concentrate on imported and sensitive equipment. Having grown up in a technical environment, it was but natural for me to have an attraction for mechanical things. My focus as far as repair and recovery was concerned was to have better capabilities to keep weapon systems and equipment in good working order. Because we had to keep a fairly large inventory of older equipment going, we had to fabricate spares and make innovations. I awarded the maximum possible chief's commendations 'on the spot' for good work done and for the most innovative ideas to encourage out-of-the-box thinking and creativity. The screening of the deserving individuals was done by their superior officers in advance.

As far as the medical infrastructure is concerned, my focus was on upgradation and creation of facilities to make the command hospitals and military hospitals, such as the one in Guwahati, on par